Legalese: practice

Name: Class: Date:

Use the legal words from the story. Four short exercises, then two questions to talk about.
Use as palavras jurídicas da notícia. Quatro exercícios curtos e duas perguntas para conversar. Online, you can check each answer right away.

1 Match the word to its meaning

1 Read the word.
2 Find its meaning. Write the letter on the line.

EXAMPLE *trial = a meeting in court where a judge or a jury decides a case* → **Z**

a.	allegation _____	A	The person accused in a court case
b.	subpoena _____	B	An agreement that ends a lawsuit before a court decides
c.	verdict _____	C	The decision at the end of a trial
d.	charges _____	D	A request to a higher court to change a decision
e.	appeal _____	E	A claim that someone did something wrong, not yet proved
f.	evidence _____	F	A formal accusation that someone committed a crime
g.	defendant _____	G	A legal order to testify or to hand over documents
h.	settlement _____	H	Facts or objects that help show something is true

2 Fill the gaps

1 Read the sentence.
2 Write a word from the box on the line.
3 Use each word one time.

EXAMPLE *The woman said she was not guilty, so there will be a* **trial** .

deny **indictment** **investigate** **plead guilty** **press charges** **sentence** **sue** **testify**

a. The store owner wants the police to take the case seriously, so she will _____ against the man who took the money.

b. A shop says the company sold broken phones. The company will _____ the claim and says it did nothing wrong.

c. The city will _____ what caused the fire. Experts will look at the building and talk to people.

d. The manager will _____ in court and say what she saw.

e. Two neighbors cannot agree about money. One of them decided to _____ the other in court.

f. A grand jury voted to approve an _____, so the case will go to trial.

g. The man decided to _____, so there was no trial.

h. The judge gave her a _____ of two years in prison.

3 Which step of the case?

1 Read the situation.
2 Choose the step (1 to 6). Write the number in the box.

1 Someone makes a claim
2 People look into it
3 Questions in public
4 Prosecutors decide on charges
5 Plea or trial
6 Verdict and after

EXAMPLE *A judge says a man must go to prison for five years.* → *step* **6**

a. Prosecutors say they have enough evidence and accuse a man of stealing. ☐

b. A newspaper says a mayor took gifts from a company. The mayor says it is not true. ☐

c. The woman tells the judge, "I am not guilty." The trial starts on Monday. ☐

d. A committee asks a CEO to come and answer questions about a product. ☐

e. Lawyers from outside the company read emails and talk to workers to find out what happened. ☐

f. The jury says, "Not guilty." The man leaves the court. ☐

4 Confirmed, only claimed, or not reported?

1 Read the statement about the Nvidia story. It is true as of 12 November 2026.
2 Mark one answer.
3 Think: has someone proved it?

EXAMPLE *Huang sent a letter to employees.* → **Confirmed**

a. The woman gathered information for China.
○ Confirmed ○ Only claimed ○ Not reported

b. Huang has been charged with a crime.
○ Confirmed ○ Only claimed ○ Not reported

c. Huang admitted that he had an affair.
○ Confirmed ○ Only claimed ○ Not reported

d. Congress ordered Huang to appear on November 18.
○ Confirmed ○ Only claimed ○ Not reported

e. Nvidia's board opened an investigation.
○ Confirmed ○ Only claimed ○ Not reported

Talk about it

1. Think of a news story where someone **denied** a claim. What was the **allegation**? Was there any **evidence**?
2. A newspaper says a company did something wrong, but no one has filed **charges**. Should people believe the story? Why or why not?